Barry James
Swindon Borough Council
Planning Department
Wat Tyler House
Swindon
SN1 2JH

bjames4@swindon.gov.uk

Bristol
3rd Floor
Beacon Tower
Colston Street
Bristol BS1 4UX

nexusplanning.co.uk

17 October 2024

Dear Barry

SOUTH MARSTON, SWINDON (PARCELS R6 and R7): RESERVED MATTERS APPLICATION (S/RES/24/0947)

On behalf of my client, Vistry Homes Limited ("Vistry"), I enclose a package of revised information that has been prepared in relation to a reserved matters planning application for 137 dwellings on Parcels R6 and R7 of the development South Marston.

The submission has been prepared in response to the consultation responses that have been received and further to the PPA/Stakeholder meeting with your colleague Edward Snook that took place on 26th September 2024. The feedback received has led to amendments to the proposals which are explained in the tables below.

Submission

The table below lists the drawings that are being submitted and describes how they relate to the original submission, made in August 2024.

Title	Reference	Notes
Consolidated Drawing and Document Schedule	17th October 2024	Supersedes Submission Schedule dated 12th August 2024
Planning Layout	PL-03 E	Supersedes PL-03
Materials Plan	PL-04 B	Supersedes PL-04 A
External Works Plan	PL-05 A	Supersedes PL-05
Boundary Treatments	PL-05.1 A	Supersedes PL-05.1
Affordable Homes Plan	PL-06 A	Supersedes PL-06
EV Charging Plan	PL-07 A	Supersedes PL-07
Parking Plan	PL-08 A	Supersedes PL-08
Garden Sizes Plan	PL-10	New Drawing
Presentation Layout	PR-03 A	Supersedes PR-03
Street Scenes	SS-01 A	Supersedes SS-01

Title	Reference	Notes
Street Scenes	SS-02 A	Supersedes SS-02
Housetype Planning Drawing Cooper-01	HT-COO-01	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Cooper-02	HT-COO-02	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Elmslie-01	HT-ELM-01	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Elmslie-02	HT-ELM-02	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-01	HT-ASH-01	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-02	HT-ASH-02	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-03	HT-ASH-03	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-04	HT-ASH-04	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-05	HT-ASH-05	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-06	HT-ASH-06	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Speirs-01	HT-SPE-01	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Speirs-02	HT-SPE-02	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Speirs-03	HT-SPE-03	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Speirs-04	HT-SPE-04	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing X307-01	HT-X307-01 A	Supersedes HT-X307-01
Housetype Planning Drawing X307-02	HT-X307-02 A	Supersedes HT-X307-02
Housetype Planning Drawing X307C-01	HT-X307C-01 A	Supersedes HT-X307A-01
Housetype Planning Drawing X414-01	HT-X414-01 A	Supersedes HT-X414-01
Housetype Planning Drawing X414-02	HT-X414-02 A	Supersedes HT-X414-02
Housetype Planning Drawing X414-03	HT-X414-03	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing X417-01	HT-X417-01 A	Supersedes HT-X417-01
Housetype Planning Drawing X417-03	HT-X417-03 A	Supersedes HT-X417-03
Housetype Planning Drawing X418-01	HT-X418-01 A	Supersedes HT-X418-01
Housetype Planning Drawing X418-02	HT-X418-02 A	Supersedes HT-X418-02
Housetype Planning Drawing X418-02	HT-X418-03	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing X416-01.1	HT-X416-01.1 A	Supersedes HT-X416-01.1
Housetype Planning Drawing X416-01.2	HT-X416-01.2 A	Supersedes HT-X416-01.2
Housetype Planning Drawing X416-02.1	HT-X416-02.1 A	Supersedes HT-X416-02.1
Housetype Planning Drawing X416-02.2	HT-X416-02.2 A	Supersedes HT-X416-02.2

Title	Reference	Notes
Housetype Planning Drawing Leverton-01	HT-LEV-01 A	Supersedes HT-LEV-01
Housetype Planning Drawing Pembroke-01	HT-PEM-01 A	Supersedes HT-PEM-01
Housetype Planning Drawing Pembroke -02	HT-PEM-02 A	Supersedes HT-PEM-02
Housetype Planning Drawing Cottingham-01.1	HT-COTT-01.1 A	Supersedes HT-COTT-01.1
Housetype Planning Drawing Cottingham-01.2	HT-COTT-01.2 A	Supersedes HT-COTT-01.2
Housetype Planning Drawing Cottingham-02.1	HT-COTT-02.1 A	Supersedes HT-COTT-02.1
Housetype Planning Drawing Cottingham-02.2	HT-COTT-02.2 A	Supersedes HT-COTT-02.2
Housetype Planning Drawing Cottingham-03.1	HT-COTT-02.1	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing Cottingham-03.2	HT-COTT-02.2	New Drawing
Housetype Planning Drawing AF1-01	AFF-AF1-01 A	Supersedes AFF-AF1-01
Housetype Planning Drawing Cooper-01	AFF-COO-01 A	Supersedes AFF-COO-01
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-01	AFF-ASH-01 A	Supersedes AFF-ASH-01
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-02	AFF-ASH-02 A	Supersedes AFF-ASH-02
Housetype Planning Drawing Asher-03	AFF-ASH-03 A	Supersedes AFF-ASH-03
Soft Landscape Proposals General Arrangement	IDPL LA5979-BP-400B	Supersedes IDPL LA5979-BP-400A
Soft Landscape Proposals 1 of 3	IDPL LA5979-BP-401B	Supersedes IDPL LA5979-BP-401A
Soft Landscape Proposals 2 of 3	IDPL LA5979-BP-402B	Supersedes IDPL LA5979-BP-402A
Soft Landscape Proposals 3 of 3	IDPL LA5979-BP-403B	Supersedes IDPL LA5979-BP-403A
Tree Pit Details	IDPL LA5979-BP-404	New Drawing
Landscape, Ecological & Arboricultural Management Plan	LA5979-LEAMP-01 B	Supersedes LA5979-LEAMP-01 A
Landscape, Ecological & Arboricultural Management Plan – Ecology Input	October 2024	New Document
Engineering Layout	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0100 P02	Supersedes 22568-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0100 P01

Title	Reference	Notes
Highway Layout General Arrangement	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0101 P02	Supersedes 22568-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0101 P01
Swept Path Analysis - Fire Tender	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0102 P02	Supersedes 22568-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0102 P01
Refuse Vehicle Swept Path Analysis and Bin Collection Plan	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0103 P02	Supersedes 22568-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0103 P01
Delivery Van Swept Path Analysis	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0104 P01	New Drawing
Long Section - Sheet 1	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0400 P02	Supersedes 22568-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0400 P01
Long Section - Sheet 2	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0401 P02	Supersedes 22568-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0401 P01
Long Section - Sheet 3	240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0402 P02	Supersedes 22568-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0402 P01
Design Compliance Statement	October 2024	Supersedes August 2024

Consultation Responses

The table below explains the position in respect of the issues raised in the consultation responses and describes where amendments have been made to the proposals.

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
1	**Landscape Architect (3rd September 2024)**	
1.1	*"I dislike the use of mixes of plants around the actual buildings. I do not like the mixing of grasses, herbaceous plants and 'amenity shrubs' as they all require different management regimes and timings. I have no issue with the arrangement of the planting beds themselves but dislike the use of mixes within them."*	Mixes amended to feature only ornamental shrubs and grasses. Herbaceous plants removed.
1.2	*"Perennials will be 'dead' for a period of the year as will the grasses so that only a part of each mix will appear as alive for a significant part of the year. Taken as a whole I strongly disagree with this as an approach across the site."*	Mixes amended to feature only ornamental shrubs and grasses. Grass species with year-round appeal used. Herbaceous plants removed.

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
1.3	*"Please replace these with normal blocks of single shrub species as used elsewhere on the scheme. The layout of planting is generally fine and could simply be re-divided into some smaller blocks of planting and there is more than enough variety to choose from in the 50 or so shrub species as listed."*	Mixes simplified as suggested. Drawing notes extended to advise that plants will be grouped in drifts of 3, 5, or 7 specimens to achieve the desired effect.
1.4	*"All the proposed trees are shown as 'Extra Heavy Standard – irrespective of the final stature of the individual tree species. This is not an effective way of specifying trees as most are not actually available at this size or are extremely expensive. I would prefer to see larger tree species used in key locations (correct species in the correct location type) with smaller trees specified elsewhere."*	Tree sizes amended in accordance with the variety proposed to address comment. Tree positions have been updated to the latest layout and larger trees have been proposed where sufficient space and soil volume permits.
1.5	*"Despite the same size trees being specified in the schedule, the drawing contains at least two different sized circles denoting proposed trees."*	'Tree circle' dimension reflects expected canopy size at semi maturity.
1.6	*"Plot 48 – please review the relationship of the proposed tree and the wall."*	Layout changes have removed this issue.
1.7	*"There are a number of 'useless' small slivers of space between the buildings and plot frontage hedges – front of plots 87 and 88, front of 102 & 103 (as examples). Can the design be fine-tuned to either plant out these spaces or make them wide enough to allow meaningful access?"*	Planting areas have been reviewed and narrow lawn areas have been replaced with gravel or shrub planting.
1.8	*"There are some locations where larger / longer term trees could be planted – to the south-east of Plot 7 for example?"*	Tree sizes amended to reflect the variety proposed. Tree positions have been updated to the latest layout and larger trees have been proposed where sufficient space and soil volume permits.
1.9	*"There is a likelihood of people following a natural desire line through the front of plots 57 and 58. I understand there is a hedge across part of it, but people will either walk though this or around to the left*	Layout changes have removed this issue.

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
	and under the three proposed trees. There is a similar solution adjacent to plots 126-129 which works well."	
1.10	*"There are several examples of very expensive and rather odd areas of planting – small, curved areas of geranium planting by parking bays 16 – these should be squared off with the end of the adjacent parking bays. In the same area, there is no planting shown under tree 1 No Ame arb RH."*	Removed and replaced with more suitable species.
1.11	*"This species, Amelanchier arborea Robin Hill, is an attractive but generally quite small tree. It is being specified in several locations across the site where I would rather see larger street tree species (plots 33, 44 as examples). I would also question this choice as they are also extremely expensive and generally difficult to source at this size."*	Tree sizes amended to reflect the variety of those proposed. Usage of Amelanchier has been reduced. Tree positions have been updated to the latest layout and larger trees have been proposed where sufficient space, soil volume allows.
1.12	*"Parking bays 34 – I do not believe there will be enough space for the central tree with the adjacent haunching etc. I suggest removing the central tree and moving the other two out further."*	Planting areas between parking bays have been widened to allow for additional rooting volume.
1.13	*"The triangular grass area to the immediate south of parking bays 96 will be trampled oved in the natural desire line between parking bay and front door."*	Planting removed.
1.14	*" I may have missed it but there is no detail / description / specification for tree staking and in particular tree planting in areas of open grass. Elsewhere on the wider scheme (Plots R8 / R9) the use of circles of bark mulch around the base of all trees in areas of open grass is included. This should be extended, for consistency, to this scheme. It has numerous benefits, not least of which is to protect the tree from the inevitable bashing by lawn mowers or cutting by strimmer."*	Tree pit details and planting notes specify mulching to all tree pits and specimens.
1.15	*"There are numerous individual shrubs shown as individual plants to the front of some houses. I*	Planting notes specify mulching to all tree pits and specimens.

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
	appreciate it is a fine point, but these appear to be planted into areas of grass and I suggest should also receive a circular area of bark mulch to protect them."	
1.16	*"There are several areas where there is no indication of what the garden boundary treatment might be. For example, adjacent parking bays 62, 91, 98, 99?"*	All boundary treatments are shown on the Planning Layout and the external works plan. Including the 4 plots that are mentioned: Plots 62, 91, 98 & 99: The parking bays bounded in both 1.8M high screen wall / close boarded fence.
1.17	*"I question whether it is wise to include Malus trilobata as is will drop crab apples which could be used to throw around or at the nearby houses and, I understand, whilst the fruit might generally be edible when cooked, the seeds contain toxins which are potentially harmful. I would suggest it prudent to swap out this particular species."*	Malus trilobata has been removed from scheme.
2	**Housing Strategy and Development Officer (10th September 2024)**	
2.1	*''Can I request clarification on the total size for the bedrooms in:* *AFF-ELM-01* *AFF-ASH-02* *AFF-ASH-03* *If I can have the total m2 for each bedroom in the above plots, please."*	Elmslie House Type Bed 1 = 11.9 m² Bed 2 = 8.2 m² Bed 3 = 7.8 m² (width is 2.15 m) Asher House Type Bed 1 = 13.5 m² Bed 2 = 12.9 m² Bed 3 = 7.5 m²
3	**Housing Strategy and Development Officer (12th September 2024)**	
3.1	*''I'm disappointed with the bedroom sizes for the Elmslie house type. We request 3-bed properties be suitable for 5 persons, but as bedroom 2 does not meet the NDSS for a 2-person room, this brings the property type down to a 3-bed 4-person property, which are harder to let."*	As explained at the 26/09/24 meeting (Tony Clements – Nexus Planning) the Elmslie is an open market dwelling and therefore there is no requirement to meet NDSS.

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
4	**Transport Development Management (12th September 2024)**	
4.1	*''Swept path analysis demonstrating the ability of the proposed accesses to accommodate the two- way movement of larger, transit sized vehicles, and without the need to cross the centreline of the carriageway is required''*	Amendments are made to demonstrate that safe access and two-way movements can be accommodated. The necessary changes were discussed and agreed at the meeting workshop held on 26/09/24. An additional drawing (240616-RAP-XX-XX-DR-C-0104) has been provided to demonstrate this.
4.2	*''The proposals with respect to visibility do not accord with the relevant speeds to which the Primary Street and Old Vicarage Lane will be/are subject to''*	Visibility is achieved in accordance with the required standards. Minor amendments are made to the bell mouth radii to achieve requisite standards.
4.3	*''The footpath between Parcel R7 and Old Vicarage Lane is required to have a minimum width of 2m''*	The proposed footpath within Parcel R7 does not connect directly to Old Vicarage Lane (OVL). The minimum width within the parcel is increased to 2.0m and the route connects via the northern parcel boundary to the perimeter POS area, within which the perimeter pedestrian route shown in the SDC is to be provided (via a separate RM submission).
4.4	*''The carriageway geometry with respect to traffic calming features does not accord with guidance in Manual for Streets (MfS); The layout with respect to private driveways and access to shared parking requires amending to accord with the approved design codes'*	Comments noted and amendments made.
4.5	*''Swept path analysis is required to demonstrate that the parking arrangements as proposed for Plot 43 can operate effectively''*	Comments noted and amendments made.
4.6	*''The proposals with respect to visitor parking are inadequate and do not meet the requirements set out in the Council's Parking Standards with respect to siting or design''*	Visitor parking spaces have been designed to accord with the relevant standards. The positioning of bays adjacent to the carriageway has been adjusted to provide peripheral access/egress areas for vehicles on all sides. The siting of bays within the parcels overall is a product of the overall parcel design approach. Enhanced permeability and legibility achieved via the removal of

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
		the central cul de sac in R6 renders the spaces more accessible across the parcel.
4.7	*"The provision of secure and sheltered cycle parking is required for all dwellings, including those classified as M4(3)"*	Comments note and amendments made.
5	**South Marston Parish Council (18th September 2024)**	
5.1	*"Having talked directly to the Vistry architect and planner, we believe that the whole approach lacks an appreciation of how this parcel's development sits within its immediate surroundings, the impact of the piecemeal provision of essential infrastructure and the need for the design to relate to the wider expanded village.* *Their consideration of layout etc relies heavily on the neighbouring green infrastructure and design of the footpaths and cycleways it contains. A primary example of this is the Vistry R6 which has no safe pedestrian/cycle route out of the red line area until other applications are submitted and agreed and 95% of a phase is occupied (see Phasing Plan and CADC-1 Movement Sequencing).* *We would hope that Borough Officers see the relevance of safe cycleway/pedestrian access out of the red line area for each of these applications before 95% occupancy is achieved."*	As explained at the 26/09/24 meeting the proposals relate to the reserved matters submission for parcels R6 and R7 and do not include details for future reserved matters relating to the open space areas outside the red line for these parcels. The comments of SMPC have been taken into consideration and the internal configuration of pedestrian and cycle ways that are not otherwise prescribed by the CADC/SDC have been revised to achieve logical and convenient points of connection. The layout now provides for a direct connection to the Carpenters' Walk route running north from the RM parcel. The layout has been adjusted to include multiple points of connection between the residential parcels and the perimeter footway/cycleway that around the site through the adjoining open space. The reserved matters proposals that follow will be able to provide connections to these points to ensure that pedestrian and cycle connectivity can be achieved as desired/requested.
5.2	*"Layout of R7* *Given the shape of this parcel, options for the layout area minimal. We have a concern about lack of safe pedestrian access for the dwellings fronting onto Old Vicarage Lane which has no footway and the absence of a direct route to the school."*	There is no proposed pedestrian connection from R7 to Old Vicarage Lane (OVL). The pedestrian path that connects R7 to destinations beyond the site (to the north and south) runs parallel to the OVL boundary within parcel R7 and connects to the alignment of the perimeter paths within the adjoining POS areas to the north and south. There is no route for

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
		pedestrians/cyclists proposed directly onto OVL. The route to the north connects to Carpenters' Walk.
5.3	*"Overall concept layout of R6* *We have serious concerns about the very cramped layout in R6. From direct liaison with Wimpey architect and Chief Planner, we understand the layout is a direct result of the concept in the CADC-1 for less dense housing on all boundaries to the exclusion of all other factors. Whilst we have no objection to this as a generic principle, it is responsible for resulting in a boundary of big open market housing on the outskirts, 5 hammerhead junctions at the end of multiple culs de sac and an unacceptably crowded ghetto at the centre. We do not believe blind adherence to the CADC general principle, which does not impose a specific road layout, should lead to a layout that is, in our view, completely unacceptable."*	Parcel R6 has now been significantly replanned to address these comments as relevant. Now delivering a more open and extensively connected design, in-keeping with Neighbourhood Planning Policy and the CADC. An additional section in the Design Compliance Statement (DCS) clearly outlines the provision of multiple walking and cycling routes through the proposed development. In response to an in-person meeting with South Marston Parish Council (SMPC) and the 26/09/24 meeting with Swindon Borough Council (SBC) & SMPC the amended layout provides convenient and legible connection to the desired Carpenters' Walk route, which remains indicative within the adjoining POS. The provision of approved connection points will act as direct influencing factor on the detailed layout for the POS within this RM area and will help to determine the details of the Open Spaces (POS). The reserved matters are made subject to approved regulating plans/codes that provide certainty and prescribe expected design approaches that are to be adopted. The submission is in accordance with the regulatory framework.
5.4	*"Road Layout within R6* *The road layout is in conflict with the South Marston Neighbourhood Plan Policy NP4 which states 'Large cul de sacs…. will be discouraged'. We would add that the profusion of cul de sacs each ending in turning spaces, also lacks the required legibility in navigating within this parcel.*	Two new road types are introduced to the layout to address comments made: The Mews Lane and the Shared Surface Street. These roads replace the cul-de-sac arrangement and benefit the R6 layout by opening the parcel to improve connectivity and legibility and allow for a reduction in turning heads. Focal tree planting is used for wayfinding to access pedestrian connection points from within and outside

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
	The 'ghetto' in the centre (the main affordable housing area) has no visitor parking anywhere near, emphasizing its cramped nature. *On the main left turn entry to the parcel from the Primary Street, views are dominated by a long, virtually continuous run of parallel car parking in front of the dwellings. The interspersed street trees appear to be planted in concrete since there is no internal green infrastructure or other landscaping/verges so would not deliver the required 'filtering' of views under the parking requirements of CADC-1."*	the development. Footways take priority over the running carriageway to allow access over proposed turning heads into the POS. The primary street provides a dedicated 3m cycleway and both the Primary Street and Tertiary Streets have 2m footpaths to both sides of the carriageway. The Mews Lane and Shared Surface Streets are proposed at 7m width overall with 6m carriageway and 1m verge combined. These streets are punctuated with tree planting to soften their character. In addition, the dwellings on the southern Tertiary Streets have been replanned to reduce frontage parking and create significant areas for tree planting and landscape buffers. Focal build outs are introduced on the northern and southern Tertiary Streets to deliver traffic calming and focal tree planting. The use of the term 'ghetto' within the comments provided by SMPC is inappropriate and should not be treated as material to any proper consideration of the merits of the proposed scheme.
5.5	*"Potential for a better layout* *We consider that there are good reasons why the general principle of less dense housing on the southern boundary of R6 should be reconsidered. This is the area most affected by railway noise (see CADC-1) and where housing mass may be appropriate. The Vistry planner indicates that the noise level is such that it is not an over-riding issue in the design, but it is still something that should be considered, particularly if an alternative offers additional benefits.* *We have stated in previous responses that we would not object to 2.5 storey buildings on this boundary, and particularly if that enables two dwellings on the same footprint. The latter may provide the ability to distribute the affordable housing more evenly around the site. Nor would we object to semi-detached*	The comments in this regard have been discussed during two in-person meetings with representatives of SMPC. On each occasion it was explained that the noise report that forms part of the RM submission describes why the configuration of the proposed layout is appropriate when considered in the context of noise sources that affect the site. There is no requirement to amend the layout to achieve noise mitigation. The CADC describes the urban grain that is appropriate at this edge. The proposed layout accords with the provisions of the CADC. It is acknowledged that SMPC would prefer an alternative design response to that which is proposed. However, there is no requirement to achieve a more

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
	housing which offers better options in removing parallel parking from the frontage of houses internal to the parcel. It also distributes visitor parking more evenly between open market and affordable housing."	dense/taller configuration for the purposes of noise mitigation, and the proposed layout accords with the terms of the CADC. There is no requirement to amend the layout as suggested by the SMPC comments.
5.6	*"Parking* *We already experience problems with new build estate and insufficient ad hoc parking provision, particularly with the increase in online deliveries. We are acutely aware that South Marston expanded village will still be very much a car-borne community – we have no guarantee of a bus service running through the village.* *In new estates, the road widths and frontage parking on dwelling plots severely limit the safe potential for ad hoc roadside parking which we have elsewhere in the village. With multiple similar housing parcels south of the village, the only potential ad hoc parking we have is along the Primary Street verges/kerbs, on some of the rural stretches of secondary roads and Bridleway 4.* *We are concerned about the overall amount available and would ask that Borough Officers check that it is judged adequate in the light of the above. Visitor parking in R6 at the moment is on the external boundaries of the site, with none close to the affordable housing.* *Bearing in mind that affordable housing should be tenure blind not just in terms of design, but also availability of parking, this is inappropriate. The 'ghetto' design means visitors are inside the central 'allocated parking area' before they find there is no space to park. Our suggestion of a more distributed layout of affordable housing would avoid this."*	The level of parking provision proposed meets the Council standards for a development of this scale. The configuration of assigned and on plot parking is in accordance with the provisions of the CADC. Visitor parking achieves the required quantum to meet the relevant standards. The distribution of visitor spaces has been revised to provide spaces within the parcels (R6) to a limited extent. Most visitor spaces are arranged adjacent to the carriageway around the perimeter of the scheme. Landscaping is interspersed. The cul-de-sac in the centre of R6 proposed by the original scheme has been revised to achieve enhanced permeability across the parcel. Pedestrian wayfinding is clear and convenient such that walking routes between the spaces and dwellings across R6 is unencumbered. The configuration is in accordance with the relevant standards.
5.7	*"Street Scene (R6 and R7)*	Please see response to 8.3.

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
	We dislike the standard colour palette and identical roof lines along street views. This is not in keeping with the Taylor Wimpey R8 and R9 design nor with the rest of the village and it lacks legibility. We believe building design should complement neighbouring design, not impose a uniformity that adds to the feeling that the external facing dwellings 'enclose' the parcel, particularly if the central area looks like a ghetto dominated by parked cars."	
5.8	*"Safe Access for pedestrians and cyclists* *There is no safe pedestrian and cycle access out of the red line to the school at all until the remainder of the Primary Street is completed up to western edge of the Taylor Wimpey site. The timing of that is not determined by this application.* *Access to the local school and Village Centre relies on the surfaced routes across the intervening green infrastructure being fit for purpose in connecting with Carpenters Walk, but those plans are not yet available and trigger points for delivery may make this very late in the occupation process.* *No pedestrian links are provided to access the Carpenters Walk route to the Village Hall/School internally or at the northern boundary of the site.* *In terms of wider connectivity, R6 and R7 will, according to the agreed Phasing Plan, have no safe cycle access out of the village (acknowledged to be a key sustainability factor) until at least 95% of the whole build phase is occupied.* *Even then, there are only two potential off-road cycleway routes that could be provided:* • *The Primary Street cycleway, which leads only to the railway footbridge with no guarantee that the ramps or link to the A420 on third party land will be delivered even after 300 houses are occupied.*	As noted above (5.3) the comments relate principally to matters outside the scope of this RM submission. The layout is amended to provide multiple (6) pedestrian and cycle links from R6 and R7 (to the north, south and west) to the perimeter path/route through the surrounding POS. The points of connection provide direct and logical routes from the parcels to the proposed (indicative) route through the adjoining POS and on to the approved Carpenters' Walk route that runs through the approved residential parcel to the north (Taylor Wimpey).

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
	Note the Primary Street approach to Thornhill Road will not carry an adjacent cycleway. • *The Bridleway 4 route to Morses Lane, where the junction with Thornhill Rd was deemed 'unsafe', but could be improved via the separately planned SBC traffic calming initiative and reduced speed limit* *Note For R7, Old Vicarage Lane is not a safe cycle or walking route as it has no roadside footway so dwellings fronting OVL do not have safe routes. The Carpenters Arms bridge at the A420 junction has been judged by SBC Highways Officers as not suitable for walkers or cyclists.* *We need the Borough and the developers to tell us just what is the appropriate safe route for cyclists out of the village for the first 300 occupiers of Phase 1 South Marston."*	
5.9	*"Future Maintenance of Green Infrastructure* *Following discussions with Vistry senior management, we are negotiating on the potential for South Marston Parish Council to take on the eventual management of green infrastructure. Within the FLEAMP, Section 6 specifically identifies that maintenance will be handed over to a management company. This should be re-worded as 'management entity' which is consistent with the overall strategic Open Space strategy for the development."*	Comments noted. The point raised is a matter that does not affect the merits of the proposals subject to this RM submission.
5.10	*"Provision for Utilities Infrastructure* *We reiterate our concern that there is no strategic approach to the provision of utilities, and we would welcome some indication of the principle of undergrounding of overhead wires (power and telephone) that currently cross the site and its neighbouring strategic open space."*	Comments noted. The points raised are beyond the scope of this RM submission.

Ref	Issues Raised	Response
6	**Flood Risk Engineer (19th September 2024)**	
6.1	*''Response: The detailed drainage strategy is not required as part of the RM package, although its design will have a bearing on the layout to be approved under the RM submission.* *LLFA: disagree with the above response. Swindon has had very recent detrimental flooding in 2023 therefore it is very important to get the drainage design right for each phase/site.* *Please submit/ resubmit as first part of Condition 42 for this application''*	Drainage details sufficient to demonstrate that parcels R6 and R7 can be drained in accordance with the discharge rates of the approved drainage strategy are provided. The RM submission includes a drainage design that will achieve the requirements of the approved strategy.
7	**Arboriculture (23rd September 2024)**	
7.1	*"I note the comments from the council's landscape officer (memorandum dated 03/09/2024) and agree with the proposed species' size and longevity concerns (point 11), the conflict with the tree and boundary wall (point 6), the improved arrangement for the planting adjacent to the parking bays (point 12 and the improvement to the proposed tree offer generally across the site (point 8)."*	Tree sizes amended to reflect the variety of those proposed. Tree positions have been updated to the latest layout and larger trees have been proposed where sufficient space, soil volume allows. Tree pit details have been produced. Soil cells have been proposed to provide additional soil volume.
7.2	*"There are several potential conflict areas between the existing trees and the proposed layout. As this is a reserved matters application, it is appropriate to consider these at this this stage: the trees (and hedgerow – H34) adjacent to the head of the cul-de-sac (road 11) between plots 70 and 91; the visitor parking spaces west of 76 to 78; the dwelling footprint within plot 75 and the drain through the centre of the hedge along the southern boundary. It is likely that the root protection areas of the respective trees and hedges are compromised, and information is needed to accurately assess the short- and long-term implications. Some of the conflicts may well be resolvable with appropriate mitigation, without a*	Hedge H34 has not been subject to targeted management for several years and as consequently is now an outgrown hedge/group of trees. To facilitate the layout proposals, areas will be brought into a routine management regime through pruning of some of the sprawling growth. Ongoing management of this nature will reduce the width of the hedge and stabilise/improve its form thereby securing its longer-term retention. Several trees situated within H34 are assessed as category U (unfit for retention), and therefore are proposed for removal due to their incompatibility with a

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	change in the design, but others may require a more fundamental amendment. Information, consistent with BS5837:2012, should be submitted to demonstrate that the trees indicated on the plans as being retained can be done so in practice."	residential use of the land (on safety grounds). The U categorisation applies to trees T46, T47 and T50. The tree adjacent to the turning head between plots 70 and 91 (T48) is not affected by the proposed works because the RPA does not extend into the works area. T48, adjacent to plot 90, will need to be heavily coppiced due to leaning acutely westwards over the proposed road alignment. The tree would thereafter re-grow and be managed to ensure its longer-term retention limiting any impact on the tree stock. The proposed visitor parking spaces adjacent to plots 74 to 76 are outside of the RPA of H35, and therefore would not impact this hedgerow. Tree protection measures will be in place throughout the construction phase of the development, along with site visits from the Arboricultural Clerk of Works to ensure compliance with the submitted AMS and Tree Protection Plans.
7.3	*"Several areas within the layout do not appear to be consistent with the approved strategic design code or the character area design code. The in-parcel tree strategy promotes the use of species that are larger at maturity where space permits and, as noted by my landscape colleague, there are spaces that would benefit from this approach within the scheme. The character area design code produced a vision diagram that mapped out a landscape-led gateway either side of the Primary Street in the southeast part of the site. Despite this also featuring on the Regulating Plan, the connection of the Primary Street and site entrance is afforded a very underwhelming gateway. Within the Primary Street coding instructions, the verges should contain tree planting that alternates side to create a slight deviation in the traffic flow and to control vehicle speed. Whilst there are some trees shown on alternate sides of the road, the submitted landscape scheme portrays them as merely end stops to visitor parking*	Tree sizes amended to reflect the variety of those proposed. Tree positions have been updated to the latest layout and larger trees have been proposed where sufficient space, soil volume allows. Tree pit details have been produced. Soil cells have been proposed to provide additional soil volume.

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	bays. This is in direct contrast to the indicative axonometric view of the Primary Street frontage, presented as a component of the mandatory coding plan within the character area design code. The character area is also aimed at managing how the on-street continuous parking spaces should be broken up by tree planting but the spaces in front of plots 63 to 84 seem not to comply."	
7.4	*"As my landscape colleague has identified, there is no tree pit construction information and this will need to be provided. Details should be included as to how the provision of sufficient soil for the relevant species into maturity can be met whilst adhering to the requirements of the council's highway team in respect of construction within, or adjacent to, the carriageway."*	This submission includes a Tree Pit Details drawing.
8	**Senior Urban Designer (24th October 2024)**	
8.1	*"**Block Structure:** The block structure, particularly the large central block in parcel R7, appears to create a cramped environment for many of the plots with a streetscene dominated by car parking. The configuration of the block here is too large and in particular too deep to achieve a satisfactory traditional perimeter block. Instead half the block is compromised by frontages facing backs/sides and a large turning head is required to manoeuvre refuse vehicles and to achieve access to properties."*	As stated in our response to point 5.4 the revisions to the road hierarchy and the resident parking placement have resulted in a significant change to the block structure of Parcel R6. This has provided a more legible and permeable layout with improved connectivity and enhanced landscaping features, which act as wayfinding focal points within the scheme.
8.2	*"**Street scenes, urban/village character** – There is a lack of continuity of frontage and/or a lack of composition across streets. What we are looking for on this site are a series of characterful streets. This requires a lot more consideration of achieving a more continuous form of building line. Strong and consistent approach to boundary treatments throughout, and a more place-based approach to delivering a sense of character.*	Revisions to block structure, road layout, resident parking placement and architectural detailing have now combined to soften the urban grain and introduce greater intervisibiity between the Primary Street and the perimeter open space. Greater variation in architectural detailing and enhanced articulation within elevations (fenestration changes and use of brick detailing) has introduced the variation sought.

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	At present the scheme's character is heavily influenced by the design of the public highway and car parking. This should be reversed to establish a landscape and urban design-led approach to place. Take the main routes and edges of the scheme and apply a place-based approach. This should be the starting point – move building types to suit the street type, use boundary treatments to suit the intended character and manoeuvre the design of the street including verges, trees and any other spaces to establish the 'vision' or 'identity' of the place."	All parcel frontages have been provided within the parameters of the CADC and now deliver enhanced placemaking and legibility provided by elevational treatments such as the introduction of varied brick detailing. The language of the roofscape is more varied than previously proposed; the introduction of different porches and alternating porch styles provides greater variety within the proposed Primary, Tertiary, Mews and Shared Surface Streets. Revisions have improved the opportunities for robust landscape design and placemaking within the street; on-plot, and to help improve way-finding through Parcel R6 to the perimeter POS and visitor parking.
8.3	*"**Architecture and character -** the architecture of the dwellings should be enhanced from the currently proposed street scenes to be much more characterful. The current street scenes (example snippets below) are lacking in quality and character and with some revisions could be severely improved.* *Roof forms for instance could be more animated with a more playful response to the resulting 'place'.* *By this I refer to the inclusion of more gable-fronted properties/aspects, a mix of dormer windows, possibly bay windows, door and window surrounds, chimneys, front porches, recessed porches and brick detailing. Such are the details and forms of buildings within more rural settings/villages that when applied to a much more urban context, will be more characterful. This in turn adds to the feel and value of the environment and the quality of development, and contributes to its distinctive character. There are also examples where a more simple, stripped down version of typologies can work, but this needs to be matched with very careful detailing, materials and landscape architecture to suit this approach.* *The quality and character of streets is not limited to the architecture of the facades only and is also heavily*	Proposed revisions to the each of the character frontages in Parcels R6 & R7 are as follows: **Old Vicarage Lane** This frontage uses render and reconstituted stone facing materials to reflect the character of existing dwellings along Old Vicarage Lane. A combination of hipped roofs on semi-detached dwellings and gable fronted elevations for detached dwellings vary the built form in line the with CADC. Brick band courses are introduced into stone facades, with brick plinth courses for rendered dwellings. These features combined with the use of chimneys, dual aspects to focal corners, and varied heritage coloured front doors, produce a street scene that is complimentary to this existing approach to the South Marston Village. **Primary Street** Alternating roof and porch forms on semi-detached dwellings varies the design language in the streetscene, while driveway parking to the side of dwellings maintains a regular rhythm (R7). On the opposing side of the street (R6) direct vehicular access is limited with rear-servicing the predominant approach. Consequently, the streetscene is composed mainly of detached dwelling

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	dependent on the other elements that make place: landscape design, street trees, lighting columns, boundary treatments, choice of materials, setback of frontages, building lines, etc."	frontages with enhanced articulation including brick band coursing to the ground floor, chimneys, bay windows and varied traditional porch forms. All dwellings on Primary Streets will be bounded by railings with landscaping behind to define the public and private spaces. **Parkland Edge** Brick band coursing is added to the ground floor of the brick dwellings along this frontage. Enhanced window cill treatments and greater use of detached gable fronted dwellings increase the variety of built form within the frontages addressing the green space surrounding parcel R6 to the north, west, and south. The boundary treatments are soft-planted, to compliment the more organic build line, increased front garden sizes and the adjacent POS. **Tertiary Streets** Focal areas have been formed within the tertiary streets to deliver traffic calming and focal tree planting. Plots are characterised by varied roof and porch forms, railings to define the private and public realm, and block paving to define the carriageway.
8.4	*''**Materials:** whilst the Character Area Design Code (CADC) provides options of 4 materials, in these parcels it is suggested that the range of materials used be reduced to a much more simplified palette. In particular, it would be more effective to apply the choice of materials to the proposal once the house types and street scenes are more developed. It could be that only one main material (say brick) is used with another contrasting material for accents such as surrounds etc.''*	The materials palette outlined in the CADC is applied to differentiate the multiple frontages within the development, while retaining a simple architectural language. Variation of form and detailing enhance the legibility of dwellings. Within the Old Vicarage Lane frontage, reconstituted stone and render are used to reflect existing materials. The remainder of Parcel R7 and Parcel R6 utilise brick

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		facing material with occasional weatherboarding along the Parkland Edge, to reflect a more rural aesthetic. Brick detailing, boundary, and porch treatments are described in response to point 8.3, above and provide a clear definition for each of the frontages.
9	**Consultant Ecologist (27th September 2024)**	
9.1	*"The Landscape Officers comprehensive response to the scheme (x17no. points raised in their memo letter dated 3.9.24 on the planting scheme) states "…Not acceptable in its current format - subject to changes noted below…". Further to this, an additional comment regarding the LEAMP was that it; "…was more of a landscape management plan…" The statement above stating it is not acceptable is also applicable to ecology for the reasons outlined below."*	Noted. This submission includes a document titled 'Landscape, Ecological & Arboricultural Management Plan – Ecology Input' which has been prepared by FPCR. It contains the ecology related information requested by the Consultant Ecologist and the Landscape Architect.
9.2	*Under Section 6.0 Management Responsibilities, for completeness, I would like to see reference again to a Suitably Qualified Ecologist (SQE) role as part of any long term management team in order to deliver, review and monitor the site against the LEAMP in respect of ecology and associated landscape planting, and that "…all landscape maintenance operations, do not conflict with ecology operations" (7.2) as stated in 7.5* *''7.5 "…The Contractor will be responsible for retaining the appropriate ecologists to carry out the monitoring of proposed mitigation measures for protected species, including badgers located in the northwest corner of the site…"* *However, it is not stated within the LEAMP any mitigation, enhancement or monitoring in respect of Badgers, and to that extent agree with the Landscape Officer that this document is more akin to a LMP than a LEAMP"*	Please see response to 9.1.

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9.3	*"Under Section 3.0 ECOLOGICAL & ARBORICULTURAL POTENTIAL AND CONSTRAINTS , this contains hardly any ecological information on potential and/or constraints. This section needs far more detail and reference. Ther is no mention on species such as, but not limited to, birds, bats, reptiles, mammals (especially Badger)in respect of mitigation or habitat enhancement features such as hibernacula, bat and bird boxes. A monitoring regime for these is also therefore also omitted. There is no reference to the ponds ecology and/or mitigation. Enhancement and monitoring."*	Please see response to 9.1.

We consider that this submission addresses the issues raised in the consultation responses received and would be grateful if you could confirm that it has been circulated to relevant consultees. Please feel free to contact me should you require further information or wish to discuss the submission in more detail.

Yours faithfully

Daniel Sharp

Daniel Sharp
Associate Director
M 07732 687303
E d.sharp@nexusplanning.co.uk